**MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM**

FIRST SEMESTER MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2024

First Semester

Multi-Disciplinary Course - MG1MDCPOL100 - INTRODUCTION TO INDIA'S FOREIGN POLICY

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

QP CODE: 24900206

# Answer Key

1. a)1945

2. b) supports them and aligns national policies

3. b) Hyderabad

4. d) Dalai Lama

5. d) SAARC

6. b) Veto power in the UN security Council

7. a) Self Defence

8. c) Canada

9. c) Declaration on Strategic Partnershp

10. a) Tamil Nadu

## PART B

11. Protecting the interests of its farmers and agricultural industry has been the main emphasis of India's considerable participation in WTO agricultural discussions. India, a significant agricultural exporter and importer, has been actively participating in trade talks and agreements to support economic expansion.

Key areas of focus are:

Agricultural Subsidies, Market Access, Food security

Agreement on Agriculture (AOA)- This agreement deals with giving market access, reducing export subsidies and government subsidies on agricultural products. Thus, India leads efforts to reform WTO subsidy rules to enable developing countries to engage in public food stockholding for food security purposes. It also calls for making the multilateral trading system more fair and inclusive.

12. The abrogation of Article 370 in Kashmir is a highly complex and contentious issue. On one hand, the Indian government's decision to revoke the special status of Jammu and Kashmir aimed to promote economic growth, reduce corruption, and increase national security .

On the other hand, many argue that this move undermines the region's autonomy and could exacerbate tensions between India and Pakistan. The subsequent lockdown, communication blackout, and detention of local leaders have raised concerns about human rights and the well-being of the Kashmiri people.

It's essential to acknowledge the diverse perspectives on this issue, ranging from those who see it as a necessary step towards integration and development to those who view it as a threat to Kashmir's identity and self-governance. Ultimately, a nuanced understanding of the situation requires considering multiple viewpoints and evaluating the impact of this decision on the region's future.

- International Response -Domestic Politics-Humanitarian Situation etc needs to be considered .

13. While there is uncertainty over the overall nature of relations between India and China , the importance of this relationship cannot be overstated.

Trade between India and China has grown significantly in the last one decade. But there are trade imbalances and economic issues.

Ban on Chinese applications by Indian government during covid time considering security issues

Political issue : China has been against India’s entry into the NSG

Military issues: border and territorial issues eg ; 2020 galwan valley clash

Belt and road initiative by China, India is a key member of Quad,

Wuhan summit (2018) , Mamallapuram Summit (2019) Diplomatic relations

The relationship between India and China is characterized by both rivalry and cooperation. While economic ties and global issues provide avenues for collaboration, security concerns, territorial disputes, and competing regional ambitions continue to strain relations. Moving forward, the India-China relationship will likely be a mix of cautious engagement, strategic competition, and limited cooperation on global issues.

14. Neighbourhood First Policy

Launched in 2014 by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the "Neighbourhood First" policy focuses on enhancing India's ties with its immediate neighbours. It seeks to prioritize regional connectivity, economic cooperation, and cultural exchanges. This approach emphasizes the importance of having peaceful and friendly relations with countries like Nepal, Bangladesh, Bhutan, Sri Lanka, Maldives, and Afghanistan. The Neighbourhood First Policy plays a crucial role in India's broader strategy to address cross-border terrorism, particularly by fostering diplomatic and security cooperation with countries like Bangladesh, Afghanistan, and Sri Lanka. While it has made progress in building partnerships and highlighting the threat of terrorism in international forums, its effectiveness in directly countering Pakistan-based terrorism is limited due to Pakistan's refusal to cooperate on this front. It is an important component of India’s broader security strategy, but it must be complemented by military preparedness, international diplomacy, and multilateral engagement to effectively counter cross-border terrorism in the region.

15. India has strong opposition to the veto power held by the five permanent members (P5) of the UN Security Council (UNSC) — the United States, the United Kingdom, France, Russia, and China. India's stance on the veto power in the UNSC is centred around the belief that the current structure is outdated and undemocratic. India advocates for reforms that would expand the Council's membership to include more permanent members and limit or eliminate the veto power to allow for more equitable and efficient decision-making. As a rising global power, India seeks a greater role in international governance, which it believes is best achieved through a reformed, more representative Security Council. India is a key member of the G4 group, which also includes Brazil, Germany, and Japan. The G4 countries are united in their push for Security Council reform, including expanding the number of permanent members and limiting or abolishing the veto power.

16. Economic Diplomacy and trade- economic ties and remittance , trade and investment etc.

Political influence and advocacy like lobbying and political representation , advocacy for Indian relations, strengthening bilateral relations

Soft power and cultural diplomacy loke educational exchanges and promotion of Indian languages and arts .

Support in strategic partnership , peacebuilding and conflict resolution, influence in multilateral organisation . Enhancing India's Global Reputation and Image, Humanitarian and Development Cooperation.

17. Historical Context and Non-Alignment Movement, After gaining independence in 1947, India, under Nehru's leadership, prioritized economic development, social justice, and peace over military expansion. India's early foreign policy emphasized peaceful coexistence, and it chose not to participate in military alliances or arms races, instead focusing on building a strong, independent, and self-sustaining nation.

India has opposed the NPT arguing that it creates a discriminatory framework by legitimizing the nuclear status of the five permanent members of the UN Security Council (P5) while denying the same status to other countries. India, instead, calls for universal disarmament and believes that nuclear weapons should not be the preserve of any particular state or group of states. India's nuclear doctrine stresses credible minimum deterrence and no-first-use (NFU**)**, signalling that its nuclear weapons are for defensive purposes and not for initiating an arms race.

India has consistently championed disarmament initiatives in the United Nations particularly through the Disarmament Commission, the Conference on Disarmament . India has also advocated for the Convention on the Prohibition of Chemical Weapons (CWC) and Biological Weapons Convention (BWC), both of which aim to eliminate weapons of mass destruction.

18. Emerged particularly in the wake of major attacks September 11 , 2001 in US and Mumbai attacks in 2008. Counterterrorism is another important area of cooperation. India has been vocal in seeking U.S. support in addressing cross-border terrorism emanating from Pakistan. Both countries work together on intelligence-sharing, and the U.S. has designated some key terrorist groups operating in South Asia as threats to global security.

## PART C

19. India, since its independence in 1947, has been an advocate for a more just and equitable international order. The country has consistently argued that the global governance structures, including the UNSC, should better reflect the political and economic realities of the modern world. Founding member of NAM, proving stance against the post-World War II global power structure, which it saw as dominated by a handful of Western powers. India's advocacy for UNSC reform was consistent with NAM's broader goals of promoting multilateralism, equality, and the democratization of international institutions.

India's proposal include Expansion of permanent members ,Elimination or Limitation of the Veto Power , increase in the number of Non Permanent membership . in order to make it more representative and democratic . However, the resistance of the permanent members and the complexity of global geopolitics have made it difficult to achieve substantial change.

20. The Peace Clause within the WTO framework, which is particularly relevant to developing countries like India, is a key provision that has important implications for India's agricultural policy, especially concerning food security and subsidy programs.

The WTO and Agriculture: Key Agreements

The WTO's rules on agriculture are primarily governed by the Agreement on Agriculture **(**AoA**)**, which came into effect in 1995. The AoA focuses on three main pillars:

> Market access: Reducing barriers to trade in agricultural products. Domestic support: Limits on government subsidies and support to farmers. Export subsidies: Restrictions on subsidies provided to exporters of agricultural products.
>
> For India, a developing country with a large agrarian economy, these provisions have been critical in shaping its domestic agricultural policies, especially in relation to the provision of subsidies, price supports, and food security measures.

India's agricultural policies are heavily geared towards ensuring food security, with programs like the National Food Security Act (NFSA) and the Public Distribution System (PDS**)**. India's government procures large quantities of food grains (such as rice and wheat) at minimum support prices (MSPs) and distributes them to poor and vulnerable populations through Public Stockholding and Subsidies

However, the long-term security of this protection remains uncertain, and India must continue to engage in multilateral negotiations to secure its food security goals while balancing trade commitments. The Peace Clause remains a critical tool in India's agricultural policy toolkit, but it requires careful management and broader international support for sustainable and equitable global food security.

21 . The US policy of containment, which was primarily aimed at curbing the spread of communism during the Cold War, had significant implications for its relationship with India. The policy, largely associated with the US's strategic efforts to limit Soviet influence, shaped America's approach toward countries across the globe, including India. However, India's unique foreign policy and non-alignment stance during the Cold War complicated its relationship with the United States The US policy of containment during the Cold War significantly influenced its relationship with India. While both countries shared democratic values, their divergent geopolitical and strategic interests led to tensions and mistrust. India's non-alignment and its close ties with the Soviet Union were seen as counter to

US interests in containing the spread of communism. The US's alliance with Pakistan, indifference to India's security concerns, and opposition to its nuclear ambitions deepened these differences. However, the post-Cold War era has witnessed a transformation in India-US relations, as both nations have found new areas of common interest and cooperation, marking a shift from Cold War-era rivalry to strategic partnership.

22. The NAM formed during cold war as an organisation that did not align with USA OR USSR . Cincept originated in 1955. Bandung conference in Indonesia . first NAM Summit 1961 Belgrade Yugoslavia. Nehru one of the founding leaders . Principles of NAM guided by panchsheel ,respect for sovereignty, peaceful coexistence, against imperialism, racism and colonialism, disarmament, unsc reforms.
Relevance – world peace, territorial integrity and sovereignty . NAM promotes equitable world order . NAM supports the concept of sustainable development. It should be used as a platform to raise global issues like terrorism , climate change and trade protectionism.

However, the challenges of contemporary geopolitics—great power competition, the role of technology, and emerging global issues—mean that Non-alignment must be reinterpreted. Today, it is less about strict neutrality and more about navigating a complex world where states assert their independence while actively participating in multilateral forums and cooperating on global challenges. Therefore, Non-alignment's core principles—sovereignty**,** independence**,** peaceful coexistence**,** and multilateralism—continue to shape the foreign policies of many nations in the 21st century, ensuring its evolving relevance.